The Sword, the Sickle, and the Shield

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Word of the Lord

“You have appealed to the court of heaven. You have been heard, and I have stood up from My throne to call down the help you need.
I have put a sickle and a sword in your hand and a shield upon your arm.
I go before you with angels—one with a sickle and one with a sword—to prepare the path and prepare the way.
Of the increase of My kingdom and authority there is no end.
I set one up, and I take another down.

While you may feel the attacks, they have none effect.
When your faith walks in obedience to My calling, My command, My Word, and My Spirit, you go forth and do great exploits.
I rebuke the devourer and I place a hedge of protection around your heart and mind.”

The Sword – Word & Warfare

Definition: In Scripture, the sword symbolizes the Word of God and spiritual warfare.
Primary Text: Hebrews 4:12 – “The word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any two-edged sword…”
Function: It divides truth from lies, cuts away falsehood, and executes judgment (Eph 6:17; Rev 19:15).
Examples of Use:
- Gideon: “The sword of the Lord and of Gideon” (Judges 7:20).
- Jesus: Used the Word like a sword: “It is written…” (Matt 4:1–11).
- Apostles: Wielded the Word, not carnal weapons (2 Cor 10:4).

The Sickle – Harvest & Holiness

Definition: A sickle is a curved blade used to reap ripe crops. Biblically, it symbolizes harvesting souls and separating holy from unholy.
Primary Text: Joel 3:13 – “Put ye in the sickle, for the harvest is ripe.”
Function: It gathers what’s ready and cuts away what’s not (Rev 14:14–16).
Examples of Use:
- Angels in Revelation: One like the Son of Man thrusts His sickle into the earth (Rev 14:14–19).
- Priests of the Old Testament: Taught the difference between holy and unholy (Lev 10:10;

Ezek 44:23).
- Laborers in the Field: “The harvest truly is great, but the laborers are few” (Luke 10:2).

The Shield – Faith & Victory

Definition: A shield represents faith—active trust in God’s protection.
Primary Text: Ephesians 6:16 – “Above all, taking the shield of faith, wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked.”
Function: It stops the enemy’s attacks before they reach you. Faith covers your mind and heart under pressure.
Examples of Use:
- Abraham: “Fear not, Abram: I am thy shield” (Gen 15:1).
- David: “Thou, O Lord, art a shield for me” (Psalm 3:3).
- Paul: Called faith the shield that quenches every fiery dart (Eph 6:16).

Character of Those Who Wield Them

Sword Bearers: Truth-tellers, reformers, prophets, and apostles who cut through deception (Gideon, Jesus, Paul).
Sickle Bearers: Discerners, intercessors, evangelists, and laborers who separate light from darkness (Joel 3:13, Rev 14:15).
Shield Lifters: Faithful believers, shepherds, and fathers/mothers of faith who protect the flock (Abraham, David).

Call to Action

Take Up the Sickle – Discern holy from unholy, reap the souls ready for harvest.
Draw the Sword – Speak the Word boldly, cut down lies and deception.
Lift the Shield – Quench the fiery darts with faith, protect your heart and mind.
Don’t walk away sorrowful like the rich young ruler (Matt 19:16–22).

Lay down what you’ve trusted more than Christ.
Find yourself a place to get connected in the work of God. Be deliberate, be passionate, dig a work out in your community.
That’s how faith walks in obedience.

The Sword, The Sickle, and The Shield — A Charge to Laborers - The Call

Those who humble themselves, seek His face, pray, and rid themselves of selfish ambition will receive these gifts and callings. They will go forth as laborers into the harvest. They will do the work God has called them to do.